

How to Clean a Medical Facility

Dialysis clinics and medical offices are judged on details a normal office never sees. This guide covers the equipment, the nightly process, and the hot spots that decide whether the account stays.

What Makes Medical Different

In a medical building the floor is a clinical surface, not just a floor. Patients sit for hours in treatment chairs, dropped items go back into use, and inspectors look where nobody else looks: under chairs, along baseboards, and behind equipment. The standard is disinfection, not appearance.

TWO HARD RULES

Never handle red bag (biohazard) waste unless the scope specifically includes it, and never move medical equipment unless City Wide instructs you to. When in doubt, leave it and report it.

Equipment & Chemicals

- Backpack style vacuum (a hip vac or compact backpack works best around equipment)
- Dual chamber mop bucket for common areas, plus a separate dedicated bucket and yellow tools for isolation rooms
- Color coded microfiber cloths and flat mop pads for every zone (see the Color Coding System)
- Microfiber wand duster, deck brush, and a utility string mop for spills
- Hydrogen peroxide cleaner (EnviroX H2O2 117): heavy duty dilution for spills and build up, light duty for nightly mopping
- PPE: gloves, safety glasses, masks, and disposable booties for isolation areas

Know Your Floors

Identify the flooring before you build the plan: LVT, VCT, epoxy, stained concrete, ceramic tile, or terrazzo. Floor type sets the chemical choice and the care schedule (daily, monthly, quarterly, and annual work).

The Nightly Process

1. **Put on PPE** before anything else.
2. **Collect normal trash only.** Treat treatment area trash with caution: never press down on bags or compact them. Sharps end up where they should not be.
3. **Disinfect surfaces** using the correct cloth color for each zone.
4. **Clean spills first:** treat leaks and spills at the stations with heavy duty solution, deck brush, and the utility mop.

- 5. Vacuum all floors.** Move the chairs every night and vacuum under them. Vacuuming (not sweeping) is what removes fine dust and debris without spreading it. Missing this step is the single most common reason crews lose medical accounts.
- 6. Mop with the flat mop system** and light duty solution from a dual chamber bucket. Work from the far corner toward the exit, with the grain of the floor, in a light S motion. Change the pad about every 4 to 6 patient stations. Rewet after about every 6 by 10 ft section.
- 7. Check your work:** a properly mopped floor dries fast enough to walk without leaving shoe prints, with no streaks and no residue haze.
- 8. Clean common areas** as normal: lobby (corners, sills, blinds, and entry glass nightly), coffee station, restrooms, locker rooms, hallways, and offices.

Isolation Rooms

- Use the dedicated isolation kit only; those tools never clean anywhere else.
- Add PPE: safety glasses, mask, and disposable booties.
- Clean with the hydrogen peroxide disinfectant at the labeled dilution and contact time.
- Finish isolation last, then bag the tools, remove PPE, and change gloves before touching anything else.

Dialysis Hot Spot: Bicarbonate Build Up

Dialysis floors develop a white bicarbonate film that streaks when mopped wrong. On a first time takeover with heavy build up:

- 1.** Scrape the film with a flat scraper and pick up the residue.
- 2.** Apply hot water and let it dwell on the remaining film.
- 3.** Scrub with a fresh pad and minimal water for a sanding effect.
- 4.** Pick up the slurry with a mop and wringer, then return to the nightly process.

Once floors are clean, monthly machine scrubbing with light duty solution at the lowest brush pressure keeps the build up from returning.

Terminal Cleans

Some medical accounts request a terminal clean: a top to bottom disinfection of a room, working from vents, lights, and ceiling down to the floor, with every detachable item removed, disinfected, and returned. Full skin coverage, safety glasses, mask, and double gloves are standard. Terminal cleans are scheduled, scoped work; coordinate with City Wide before committing a crew.

Care for the Tools

- Rinse mop pads and cloths after the shift, wring them out, and stage them for laundry.
- Machine wash microfiber weekly at minimum, and launder isolation kit items separately.